

Notice that we have exposed the service to the outside world via the LoadBalancer; so this will result in Google Cloud provisioning a load balancer behind the scenes for you.

Now, if we query the services status after a while, we get the following output:

```
$ kubectl get services
NAME          CLUSTER-IP      EXTERNAL-IP      PORT(S)    AGE
kubernetes    10.111.240.1     <none>           <none>     443/
TCP           8m
nginx         10.111.247.193   104.154.168.17   80/
TCP           1m
```

Notice that our nginx service has got an external IP through which the service can be accessed. You might have noticed that GKE, via its inherent fully-managed service, makes the process very easy.

Google Container Registry

If you run your workload on the Google Container Engine, one of the complementary products to consider is the Google Container Registry, which provides a powerful private registry for your Docker images. The Container Registry can also be used independently, and can be integrated with Docker CLI tools. The prefix *gcr.io* is used on images in the Google Container Registry.

Google App Engine Flexible

App Engine has been one of the most popular PaaS offerings available. This is the original standard runtime that supports Java, Python, Go and PHP applications. However, developers demanded flexibility by wanting to use programming languages other than the ones this engine supported, as well as different frameworks, while enjoying the benefits of focusing on their applications and not on managing the infrastructure – which App Engine did well. The App Engine Flexible environment

uses Docker at its core in the development environment and behind the scenes deploys it to Google Container Engine. So if you are looking at a flexible PaaS environment based on Google, give App Engine Flexible a try.

Pricing

Google Cloud pricing has been considered by many to be more cost efficient vis-a-vis the other public clouds. Google has introduced pricing innovations like 'Pre-emptible instances', i.e., your instance could be shut down any time, and 'Sustained use' discounts, whereby automatic discounts are applied as you use the VMs for longer periods. This helps in significant savings. There is also a Google Cloud Platform Pricing Calculator, an interactive Web-based tool that you can use to determine your expenditure. 

References

- [1] Google Compute Engine (GCE): <https://cloud.google.com/compute/>
- [2] Google Container Engine (GKE): <https://cloud.google.com/container-engine/>
- [3] Google Container Registry (GCR): <https://cloud.google.com/container-registry/>
- [4] App Engine Flexible Runtime (GAE Flexible): <https://cloud.google.com/appengine/docs/flexible/>
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- [6] Google Cloud Free Trial: <https://console.cloud.google.com/freetrial>
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